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Click here..Click here..Click here..BOOMMM!!!

BEWARE OF SPOOFED EMAIL



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OVERVIEW

Email spoofing is a method of sending emails with a forged sender address, often used to deliver spam and phishing attacks. We have recently witnessed an increase in such emails, which involve sending fake emails in the name of a senior person in an organisation, such as MD, Group Head, CISO, CEO, etc. or from a regulatory authority such as RBI, SEBI, etc. Fake mails could also reach your inbox in the pretext of shopping sites, travel groups, hotel or flight bookings, Income Tax office etc. The options are endless for a fraudster to trick you.

These fake emails create a sense of urgency in an authoritative tone and often include particular instructions to click on links that could involve financial transactions, quick fund transfers, or the sharing of sensitive information. In most cases, since the emails carry a tone of urgency or display the name of a senior, a gullible employee can take the bait. The intent behind email spoofing is to spread malware, carry out fraudulent transactions, steal data, bypass security systems, or prepare for subsequent attacks. Let's understand this better.



INTRODUCTION

We would all like to believe that we know a scam when we see one. You probably think, "that could never happen to me, I am not that dumb", but the moment we see a mail saying "Discount, Free" the human urge to open the mail or even click the link (without thinking) is undeniable. We may receive an impersonated (fake) email from any regulatory body or seniors from the bank like our MD or Group Head, and without any delay we rush to open the email, click the link, and download attachment. We assume that it's our duty to act and respond on these mails without any second thoughts. That's exactly what a fraudster wants you to do. They want you to just click a link in a fake email or share data without thinking.

Let's bring this whole cycle to an end by being aware.

What is Email Spoofing?

In simple terms, it is a technique used in spam and phishing attacks wherein the user is tricked into thinking that the mail is from a person they can trust.

Fraudsters are using well established modus operandi of spoofing mails wherein they imitate well known credible sources like RBI, IT Returns, Amazon, Flipkart, HR department, etc. to lure you into clicking and divulging information by using enticing subject line, look-a-like email id, trusted display name, etc. The goal of email spoofing is to trick you into believing that the email is from someone you know or trust.



Information Security Group regularly conducts phishing simulation exercise to understand user behaviour and awareness about this subject. In the month of May one such simulation exercise was conducted on the theme 'Ratings and Bonus'. Many of you have fallen prey to this exercise by clicking the link, some have even divulged their data.

Here's how you can identify such fraudulent mails

1

Fake email using look-a-like email address

Display name tries to portray name of the entity being impersonated



2

On hovering, the link displays a random URL

Ideally, a proper link starts with https://followed by the name of the entity

Subject: Immediate action required for Your Ratings and Bonus Know more

From: Human Resources <humanresourses@hr-hbfc.com>
To: ABC <abc@gmail.com>
Date: Saturday, May 13, 2023 2:48 PM

Dear Amit,
We are glad to inform you that we are ready now to execute the Performance Bonus for 2023. Your performance during this period had been rated as Exceptional contributer.

In recognition of your perfomace The Management is pleased to annonuce a good hike in your annual compensation with effect from June 01, 2023.

In order to provide with the breakup of the enhanced annual compensation, we request you to please fill in the current details required by clicking here.

http://www.hbfc.orghgbFRgg

Request you to keep in mind the letter is personal and strictly

Regards,
HR HEAD, HFDC Bank Limited

3

Too many mistakes throughout the mail hence chances are it is fake

Genuine mails from corporate departments are duly reviewed before release

4

Email signature is generic and lacks contact details

Official mail footer has proper contact details and disclaimer

5

Apart from these basic check, emails originating from outside the Bank have the below warning message at the beginning of the email body.

(Warning)-This is an External Email: Be very careful before clicking on any Links/ Sharing data/Downloading attchments.

Data Leakage

You could unintentionally share sensitive information with fraudsters, putting both yourself and the company in danger.

Org-wide Network Infection

The entire company network could be compromised, halting operations and causing substantial financial loss.

Unauthorised Access

Phishing links may contain malware that can steal your credentials including passwords giving unauthorised access to your account.

Ransomware Nightmare

Fraudsters may encrypt your files and hold them for ransom by demanding money in exchange for their release without any guarantee.

CONSEQUENCES OF PHISHING EMAIL

Your single click can unleash a tsunami of disaster!

Reputation Damage

Security breaches can erode customer trust and tarnish the company's reputation, impacting future success.

Financial Losses

Unauthorised transactions due to stolen credentials could lead to severe financial losses both to the customer and the organisation.

Malware Infection

A simple click could download harmful software onto your computer, allowing cybercriminals to steal sensitive data.

QUIZ

Take this informative quiz and boost your knowledge about Password Protection

The first 5 winners will win ISG goodies!

To take this quiz,
click here

OR

Scan this QR code



FEEDBACK

If you spot a suspicious email or message, don't click!
Report suspicious mail at information.security@hdfcbank.com
Your vigilance makes all difference.

REFERENCE

- https://cybernews.com/secure-email-providers/email-spoofing
- https://www.proofpoint.com/us/threat-reference/email-spoofing